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THE SIT-IN MOVEMENT

A generation of young people has come out of decades of shadows to face naked state power; it has lost its fears, and experienced the majestic dignity of a direct struggle for its own liberation. These young people have connected up with their own history—the slave revolts, the incomplete revolution of the Civil War, the brotherhood of colonial colored men in Africa and Asia. They are an integral part of the history which is reshaping the world, replacing a dying order with modern democracy.

FEBRUARY 1, 1960
King moves with family to Atlanta; in Greensboro, North Carolina, lunch counter sit-in movement begins

FEBRUARY 17
Is arrested and charged with falsifying his 1956 and 1958 Alabama state income tax returns

APRIL 15
Speaks at founding conference of the Student Nonviolent Coordinating Committee (SNCC)

MAY 28
Is acquitted of tax evasion by an all-white jury in Montgomery

After four years as president of the Montgomery Improvement Association and five years as a resident of Montgomery, I decided to move from Montgomery to Atlanta. I would become co-pastor of the Ebenezer Baptist Church in Atlanta and thereby have more time and a better location to direct the Southwide campaigns of the SCLC.

For a year the Southern Christian Leadership Conference had been pleading with me to give it the maximum of my time, since the time was ripe for expanded militant action across the South. After giving the request serious and prayerful consideration, I came to the conclusion that I had a